PATHWAY
MINISTRIES

WELCOME

Welcome Home.

You're not here by accident.

"For I know the plans I have for you,
declares the LORD — plans to give you a future and a hope."
Jeremiah 29:11 NIV

Sunday Services

9:30 AM

Fountain Grove Park, Hyde Park · pathwaym.co.za

PATHWAY MINISTRIES · WELCOME HOME

Our Story

Who we are, why we exist, and why you belong here

A letter from our pastor

Pathway Ministries didn't start in a boardroom. It started with a prayer and a conviction — that there were people in this city who were searching for something real. People who had tried everything else and were quietly wondering if there was more to life than what they'd found so far.

If that describes you — even a little — then I believe with everything in me that you are not here by accident today.

> We are not a perfect church. We are a community of real people — with real histories, real struggles, and real faith — who have found in Jesus something worth building a life around. And we want the same for you.

You don't need to have it all figured out to belong here. You don't need the right background, the right answers, or even a strong faith. You just need to be willing to take one more step. We'll walk the rest with you.

My door is always open. Please introduce yourself to me or any member of our team today — we genuinely want to know your name.

With love and faith,

[PASTOR NAME]

Lead Pastor — Pathway Ministries

Who we are

Pathway Ministries is a Spirit-filled, Word-centred church planted in Johannesburg with one conviction: that the local church is still the greatest force for good the world has ever seen. We exist to inspire faith, build community, and see lives transformed by the gospel of Jesus Christ — one person, one family, one neighbourhood at a time.

We believe…

• the Bible is not a rule book — it's a love letter

Written over thousands of years, it tells one story: that God has been pursuing humanity with relentless love from the very beginning. We read it not out of obligation but because it is alive, and it changes things.

• Jesus is exactly who He said He was

Not a good teacher, not a moral example, not a historical figure. The Son of God, fully human and fully divine, who stepped into our broken world, died in our place, and rose again so that nothing — not our past, not our failures, not even death — would have the final word over us.

• the Holy Spirit is present and active today

When you gave your life to Jesus — or when you do — God Himself comes to live inside you. Not as a feeling, but as a Person. Your helper, your counsellor, your guide. The Christian life was never meant to be lived in your own strength.

• grace changes everything

Salvation is not earned, deserved, or maintained by good behaviour. It is a free gift, received by faith. Which means no one in this room is too far gone, too broken, or too late. If you're breathing, grace is still available to you.

• the local church is the hope of the world

Not a building. Not an institution. A family — of people committed to one another, to their community, and to the mission of Jesus. Pathway is our expression of that family, and we'd love for you to be part of it.

> *"You are no longer foreigners and strangers, but fellow citizens with God's people and also members of His household."*
>
> **Ephesians 2:19 NIV**

The Pathway journey

Everything we do at Pathway is shaped around a simple framework called the 5B journey. It's not a programme. It's not a membership ladder. It's a description of how people grow — and wherever you are right now, there is a next step with your name on it.

You are already on Step 1. The fact that you're holding this document means someone brought you here — or something did. Either way, that's not a coincidence. That's the beginning of something.

← YOU ARE HERE

B1
Be Brought

Every journey starts with an invitation. You're here. That's enough. We're not asking you to believe everything yet — just to stay.

B2
Believe

Faith begins with a decision. We believe Jesus Christ is Lord — that He died for our sins and rose again, and that through Him we have forgiveness, life and hope. This is the turning point of the journey.

B3
Belong

God designed us for community. Belonging at Pathway means finding your family — people who know your name, walk through life with you, and grow alongside you in the things of God.

B4
Become

God is always at work in us. Becoming is the daily process of being shaped into the person He created you to be — in character, in faith, in purpose and in the way you love the people around you.

B5
Build

Every believer is called to contribute. Building means using your gifts, your time and your resources to invest in others and grow the kingdom of God. This is where fulfilment lives.

Voices from our community

The most honest thing we can tell you about Pathway is what it has meant to the people who call it home. These are their words.

“I walked in not knowing a single person. Within three Sundays I had people checking in on me during the week. I’ve never experienced community like this — not even close.”

[MEMBER NAME]

Joined Pathway [MONTH YEAR]

“I came because a friend invited me. I stayed because something happened in that first service that I can’t fully explain — I just knew I was in the right place. That was eighteen months ago.”

[MEMBER NAME]

Connect Group Leader

“I had walked away from church for nearly a decade. I came back expecting to feel judged. Instead I felt welcomed. No one asked about my past. They just asked my name.”

[MEMBER NAME]

Pathway Ministries member

“The teaching here is different. It’s practical, it’s honest, and it actually helps me live my life better. I come on Sunday and I leave with something I can use on Monday.”

[MEMBER NAME]

Joined Pathway [MONTH YEAR]

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Your Journey

What to expect and how to get connected

What to expect on a Sunday

We know that walking into a new church can feel uncomfortable. So here's exactly what happens — no surprises, no pressure, no obligation.

Arrival

Our welcome team will greet you at the door. There is no dress code. No one will ask how long you've been a Christian or whether you tithe. You will be welcomed exactly as you are, full stop.

Worship

We open every service with contemporary, Spirit-led music. You are welcome to stand, sit, sing, or simply take it in. There is absolutely no pressure to participate in any way that feels uncomfortable to you.

The message

Our messages are practical, Bible-based and written for real life — not for people who already have everything figured out. Whether this is your first time in a church or you've been going your whole life, you will find something that speaks directly to where you are.

The response moment

At the end of the service we often give people an opportunity to respond. This may be a salvation prayer, a personal commitment, or an invitation for prayer. It is always 100% your choice. No one will single you out, embarrass you or pressure you. You are free to observe and process in your own time.

If you're not sure you believe any of this yet

You are still welcome. Come and see. Ask the hard questions. Sit in the back if you need to. We would rather you be here exploring than outside deciding from a distance. Faith is a journey — and every journey starts with a single step.

Children's ministry

We have age-appropriate programmes for children from [AGE] to [AGE] running at the same time as the main service. Our team is trained, vetted and genuinely passionate about helping children discover that God loves them. Check in at the kids desk before the service begins.

After the service

Stick around. Grab a coffee. Let our team know it's your first time. The conversation after the service is often where the real connections are made — and we'd love to meet you.

Get connected

The Sunday service is the front door — but real life at Pathway happens in the week. Here is how to go from visitor to family.

Get connected (continued)

Connect Groups

Small groups that meet weekly in homes across Johannesburg. Real people, real conversation, real community. This is where Pathway actually happens. If you only do one thing on this list, make it this one.

→ **Ask about connect groups at the welcome desk**

Foundations Course

A short course designed for anyone new to Pathway or new to faith. Covers the basics of Christianity, how the church works, and how to take your next steps. No prior knowledge required — just bring a willingness to learn.

→ **Ask at the welcome desk for the next date**

Water Baptism

If you've made a decision to follow Jesus, baptism is your first public step of obedience. Not a ritual — a declaration. We run baptism services regularly and would love to be part of yours.

→ **Sign up at pathwaym.co.za or at the welcome desk**

Men's Ministry

Regular gatherings for men to grow in faith, brotherhood and purpose. Breakfasts, Bible studies and outreach opportunities throughout the year.

→ **Contact [MEN'S LEADER] for the next event**

Women's Ministry

A vibrant, safe space for women to connect, be encouraged, and grow together in faith. Events, studies and genuine community throughout the year.

→ **Contact [WOMEN'S LEADER] for the next event**

Youth Ministry

For teens and young adults — a community built around authentic faith, honest questions and real belonging. Meets [DAY] at [TIME].

→ **Contact [YOUTH LEADER] or visit pathwaym.co.za/youth**

Prayer Ministry

Our prayer team is available after every service. We also hold dedicated prayer meetings on [DAY] at [TIME]. We believe prayer moves things — and we would love to stand with you in whatever you're facing.

→ **Speak to any team member after the service**

Serving & Volunteering

One of the fastest ways to feel at home in a new community is to contribute to it. We have serving opportunities across welcome, kids, worship, media and outreach. Whatever your gift, there is a place for it here.

→ **Speak to [TEAM LEAD] or fill in the connection card**

Generosity — how we fund the mission

We want to be completely transparent with you about this, because we think honesty builds trust. Pathway Ministries runs entirely on the voluntary generosity of people who call this church home. There is no government funding, no corporate sponsorship, and no price of admission.

We will never pressure you to give — especially not as a first-time visitor. But we do want to tell you what giving makes possible: the services, the children's ministry, the community outreach, the connect groups, and the team that makes all of it happen.

What the Bible says about generosity

> *"Each of you should give what you have decided in your heart to give, not reluctantly or under compulsion, for God loves a cheerful giver."*
> **2 Corinthians 9:7 NIV**

Giving at Pathway is not about obligation. It is an act of worship and an expression of trust — that God is the source of everything we have, and that investing in His kingdom is always worth it.

How to give

• Sunday offering

An offering is received during each service. You are welcome to give or simply pass the basket along — no one is watching and there is no expectation.

• SnapScan

Scan the Pathway SnapScan code displayed in the venue or on our website to give digitally. Quick, secure and available any time.

• EFT / Bank transfer

Bank: [BANK NAME] · Account: [ACCOUNT NUMBER] · Reference: [YOUR NAME]

• Online giving

Visit pathwaym.co.za to set up a recurring monthly gift or make a once-off contribution at any time.

> *"Honour the LORD with your wealth, with the firstfruits of all your crops; then your barns will be filled to overflowing."*
> **Proverbs 3:9-10 NIV**

Questions you might be thinking

We've found that most first-time visitors have the same few questions but don't always feel comfortable asking them. Here are the honest answers.

Do I have to dress up?

Not at all. Come as you are, literally. You will see everything from jeans to suits on a Sunday morning. What you wear is the last thing on our mind.

What happens to my children during the service?

We have a safe, fun, age-appropriate programme running at the same time as the main service. Your children will be checked in before the service and collected by you straight afterwards. Our team is trained and vetted.

Do I have to give money?

No. An offering is taken during the service but there is absolutely no obligation or expectation for visitors. When and if you choose to give is entirely up to you.

What if I'm not sure I believe in God?

You are still welcome. In fact, we'd argue this is exactly the right place for you. We encourage honest questions. Faith was never meant to be blind — come and explore, ask and seek. We've got time.

What if I've done things I'm ashamed of?

So has everyone in the room. Including the pastor. Grace means your past doesn't disqualify you. You are welcome here exactly as you are.

Is parking available?

[PARKING DETAILS — e.g. Free parking is available on site / Street parking is available on X Street]

How do I find out about events and services?

Follow us on Instagram and Facebook @pathwayministries, subscribe to our YouTube channel, or visit pathwaym.co.za. We also send a weekly update to everyone on our mailing list.

What's the best first step if I want to get more involved?

Fill in the connection card on the next page, or speak to anyone on our welcome team today. Joining a connect group is the single most effective way to go from visitor to family — ask about it at the welcome desk.

We'd love to hear from you

Fill in your details below and hand this to any team member or drop it in the box at the welcome desk. We follow up personally — never with spam, always with genuine care. You can also scan the QR code to complete this online.

Full name _____

Date of visit _____

Email address _____

Contact number _____

Home area / suburb _____

This is my:

- ☐ First visit
- ☐ Second or third visit
- ☐ Regularly attending

I'm interested in:

- ☐ Connect Groups
- ☐ Baptism
- ☐ Foundations Course
- ☐ Children's Ministry
- ☐ Youth Ministry
- ☐ Serving / Volunteering
- ☐ Men's Ministry
- ☐ Women's Ministry
- ☐ Prayer Ministry
- ☐ Giving / SnapScan
- ☐ Online community
- ☐ I just want more info

Prayer request or message for our team:

We read every one of these personally. Nothing is too big or too small.

_____

_____

_____

_____

> *"The LORD bless you and keep you; the LORD make His face shine on you and be gracious to you; the LORD turn His face toward you and give you peace."*
>
> **Numbers 6:24-26 NIV**